

- Now click on the Start backup button to start the process of creating a system image.

7.5 Recover lost or deleted files

If you can't find a file on your computer or you accidentally modified or deleted a file, you can restore it from your backup (if you are using Windows backup) or you can try to restore it from a previous version. Previous versions are copies of your files and folders that Windows 7 automatically saves as part of a restore point. They are sometimes referred to as shadow copies.

7.5.1 To restore a deleted file or folder

- Boot up your Computer.
- Navigate to the folder that used to contain the file or folder, right-click it, and then select 'Restore previous versions'. If the folder was at the top level of a partition, for example C:\, right-click the partition in 'Computer' and then click Restore previous versions. You'll see a list of all available previous versions of the file or folder. It will also include files saved on a backup (if you are using Windows Backup to back up your files) as well as restore points.
- Double-click the previous version of the folder that contains the file or folder you want to restore. (For example, if a file/folder was deleted today, choose a version of the folder from yesterday. It should contain the file.)
- Click and drag the file or folder that you want to restore to another location on your computer, such as your desktop or another folder. The version of the file or folder will be saved to the location that you selected.

Note

To restore a previous version of a file or folder that's included in a library, right-click the file or folder in the location where it's saved, rather than in the library. For example, to restore a previous version of a picture that's included in the Pictures library but is stored in the My Pictures folder, right-click the My Pictures folder, and then click Restore previous versions.

7.5.2 To restore a file or folder to a previous state

- Right-click the file or folder, and then click Restore previous versions.
- Before restoring a previous version of a file or folder, select the previous version, and then click Open to view it to make sure it's the version you want.

Note

You can't open or copy previous versions of files that were created by Windows Backup, but you can restore them.